BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #6 · CHRONIC PAIN

"This pain will never end."

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Where it often comes from

Pain that lasts for months or years teaches the mind to expect only more pain. Each flare confirms the fear, and hope for relief becomes dangerous. Sleep loss and worry magnify the experience.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist cries, "How long, O LORD?" and later says, "I will sing to the LORD, for He has been good to me" (Psalm 13). "For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help." "Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning." We cannot promise relief, but we can say that God hears, that you are not alone in the pain, and that today's suffering is not the whole story.

> *"For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help"* (Psalm 22:24).

Also see

> "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning" (Psalm 30:5).

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> "I consider that our present sufferings are not comparable to the glory that will be revealed in us" (Romans 8:18).

Common self-statements

- It will always be like this.
- Relief is impossible.
- I cannot survive more years of this.
- Hope just makes it worse.
- Nothing helps.
- This is my life now.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing pain is either gone or forever.
- Fortune telling: Predicting endless pain.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling pain intensely and concluding it will not end.
- Labeling: Calling myself a person in permanent pain.

Challenging questions

- What patterns do I notice in my pain, such as better and worse times?
- What has helped even a little?
- Who is on my care team, and have I told them everything?

- How have I coped before when pain eased?
- What does God do with the cry “How long?”
- What can I do today to make today a bit more bearable?

Truth summary

> God hears my cry and does not despise my pain. I cannot see the end, but I can take today one hour at a time, use every wise help available, and trust that He is with me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Suffering
- Sickness
- Hardship
- Prayer, Answers to
- Tired

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God’s care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God’s companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "This pain will never end"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"This pain will never end." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What patterns do I notice in my pain, such as better and worse times?
- ☐ What has helped even a little?
- ☐ Who is on my care team, and have I told them everything?
- ☐ How have I coped before when pain eased?
- ☐ What does God do with the cry "How long?"
- ☐ What can I do today to make today a bit more bearable?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God has not despised my torment.
- ☐ He attends to my cry for help.
- ☐ Weeping may last the night; joy comes.
- ☐ The Lord is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ His mercies are new each morning.
- ☐ I can face today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 22:24
  "For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help."
- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One hour at a time: Each day, note one thing that eased the pain a little.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 22:24 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord has not despised my torment and hears my cry.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Suffering" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Keep a pain log. Note patterns and what helps.
- [ ] Talk with your care team. Ask about new options.
- [ ] Pace your day. Plan rest and gentle activity.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 13. Tell God how you feel.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "This pain will never end": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One hour at a time
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~This pain will never end.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, the pain is wearing me down. You do not despise my suffering. Hear my cry, give strength for today, and lead me to the help I need. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.